cBioPortal
FOR CANCER GENOMICS

Tutorial 1
Single Study Exploration

Explore all data in a dataset

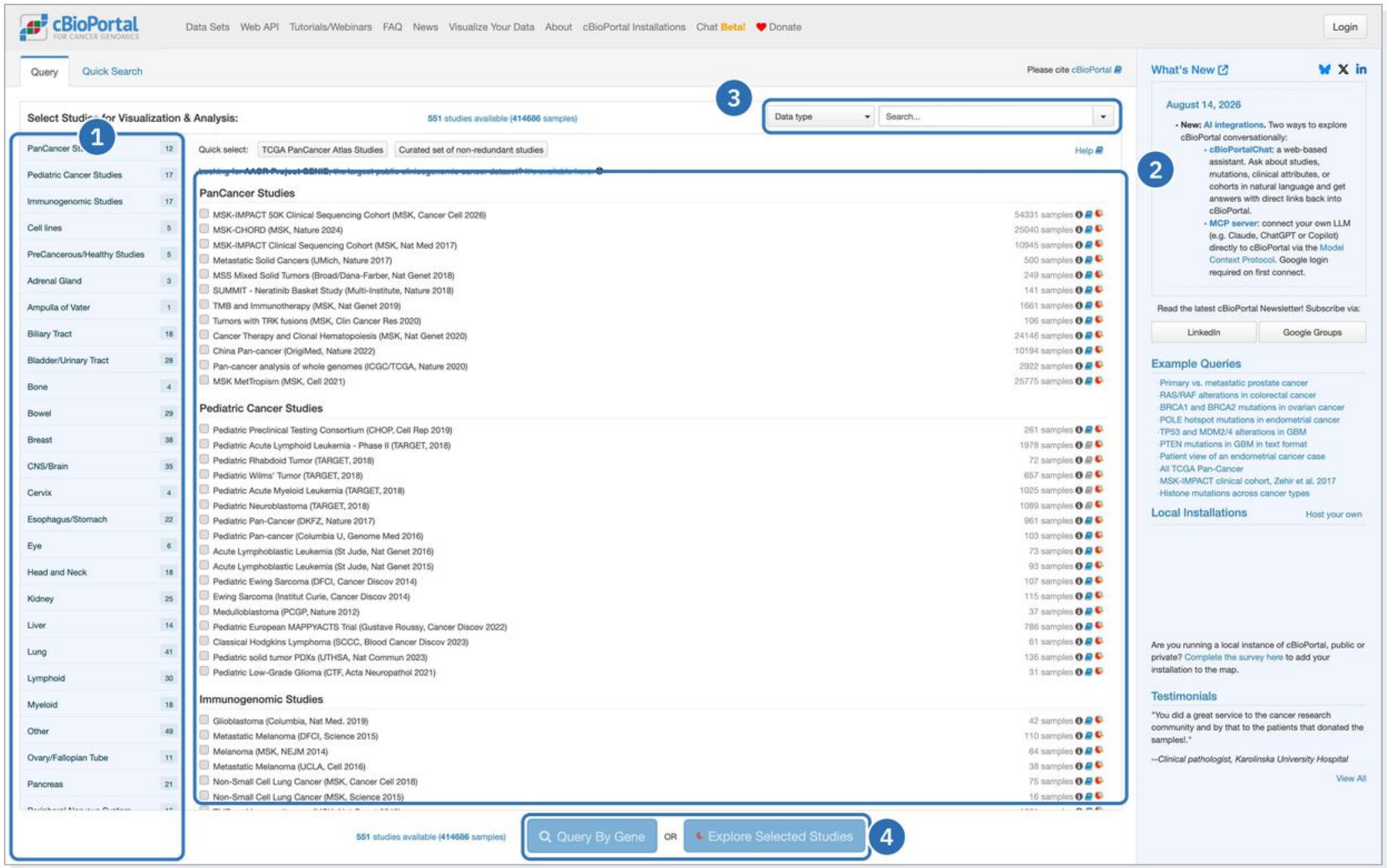
Last update: November 12, 2026

cbioportal.org/tutorials

Tutorial objectives

- Introduce the cBioPortal main page
- Find a study on the main page: search by name, or filter by data type
- Walk through the Study View tabs: Summary, Clinical Data, CN Segments, Plots and Slide Microscopy
- Add charts and select a subset of samples
- Run a query from the Study View

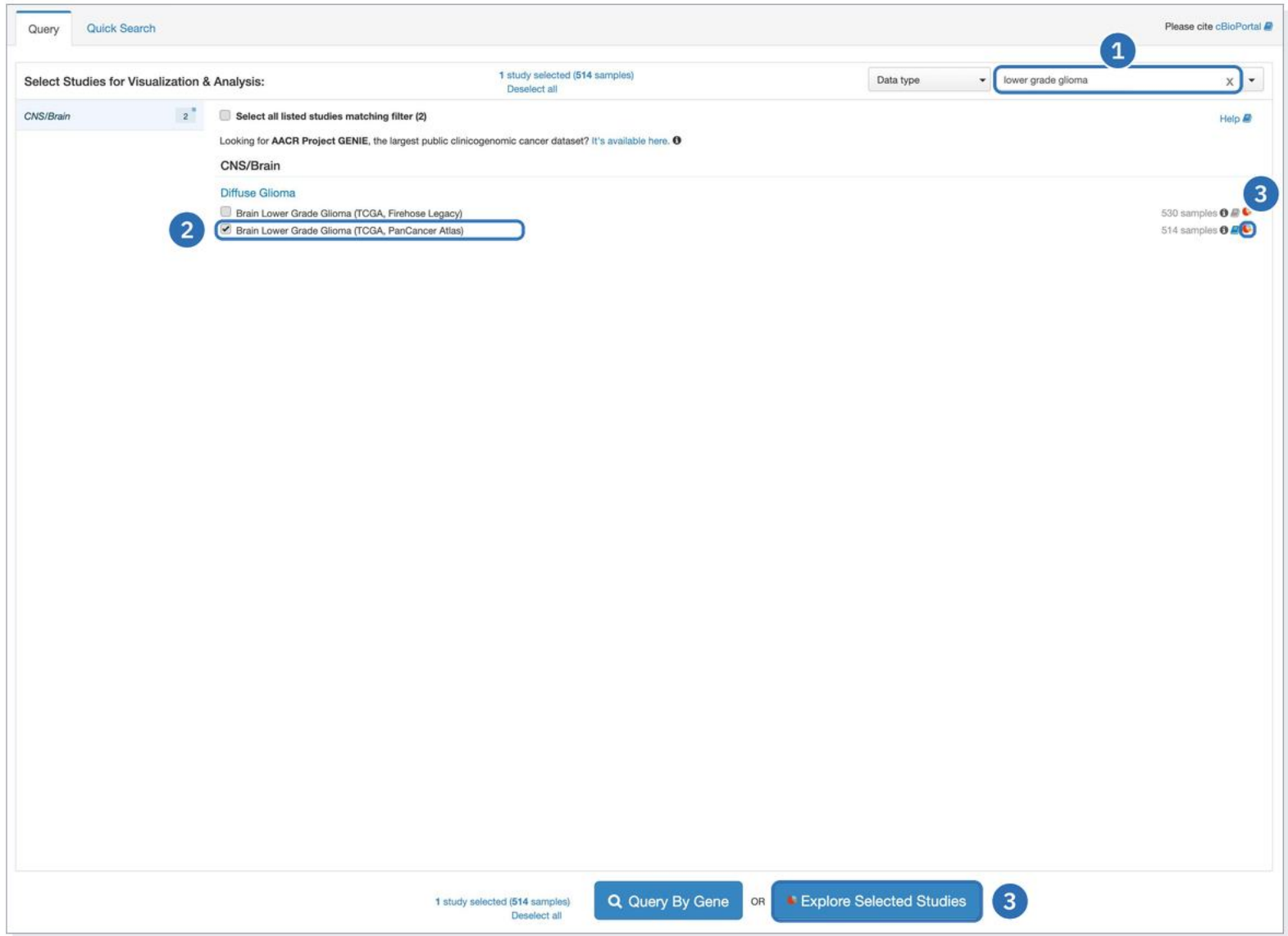
cBioPortal main page



1. Filter studies by tissue of origin.
2. Browse studies, or quick select a curated set.
3. Search studies by name or data type.
4. Start a query ("Query By Gene"), or open the selected studies ("Explore Selected Studies").

Link to this page

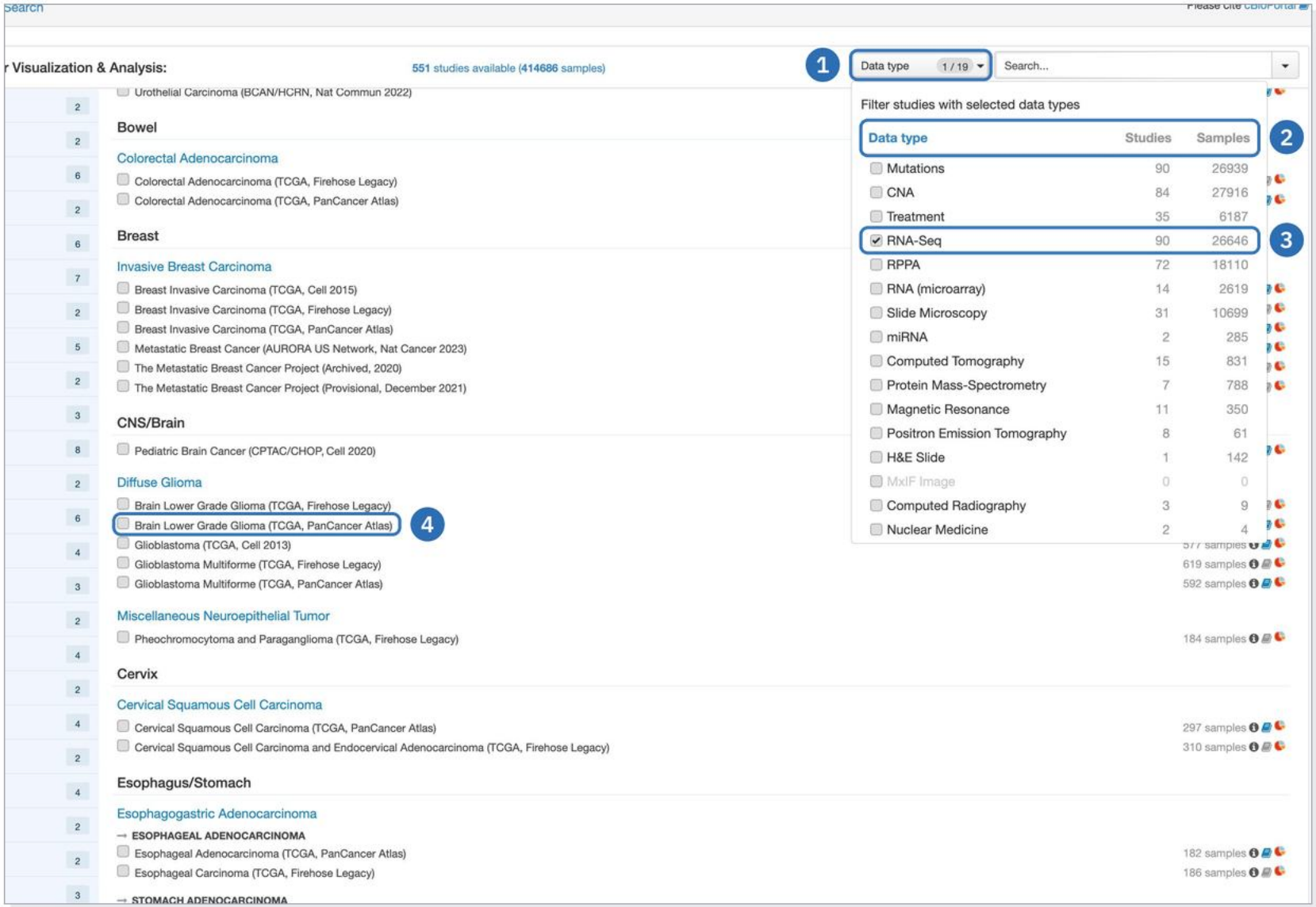
Select a study: search by name



1. Search for your study of interest by name. In this example, “lower grade glioma”.
2. Tick the study, here Brain Lower Grade Glioma (TCGA, PanCancer Atlas). The counter shows how many studies and samples are selected.
3. Then click “Explore Selected Studies”, or click the study's pie icon to open its summary directly.

Link to this page

Select a study: filter by data type



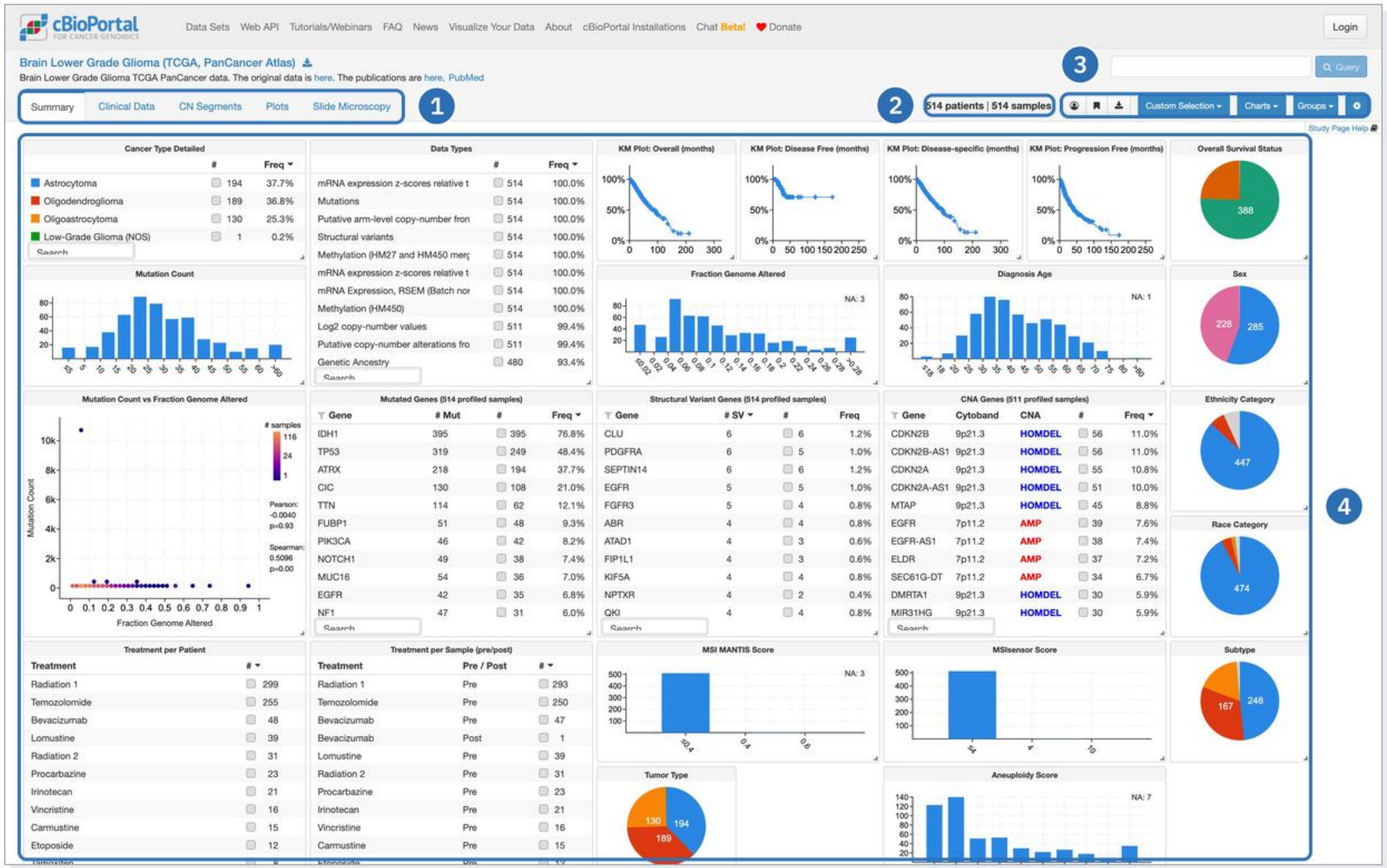
1. Or narrow the list by the data you need: open the “Data type” menu.
2. Each data type shows how many studies and samples have it.
3. Tick one or more. Here, “RNA-Seq”. The list now shows only those studies.
4. Our example study is among them: tick it and click “Explore Selected Studies”.

Link to this page

Once you select a study

- Click “Explore Selected Studies” (or the pie icon next to a study) to open the Study View on its Summary tab.
- Here you can explore features of the samples, such as mutated genes or sex, for the whole study or for a subset, and start a query.
- The charts and tabs you see depend on the data available for the study you selected.

Study View: Summary tab



1. Tabs to explore the study's data in different ways. Which tabs appear depends on the study's data.
2. The current selection: number of patients and samples.
3. Study View actions (see the next slide).
4. Every chart summarizes one attribute. Click a chart to select samples; all charts update.

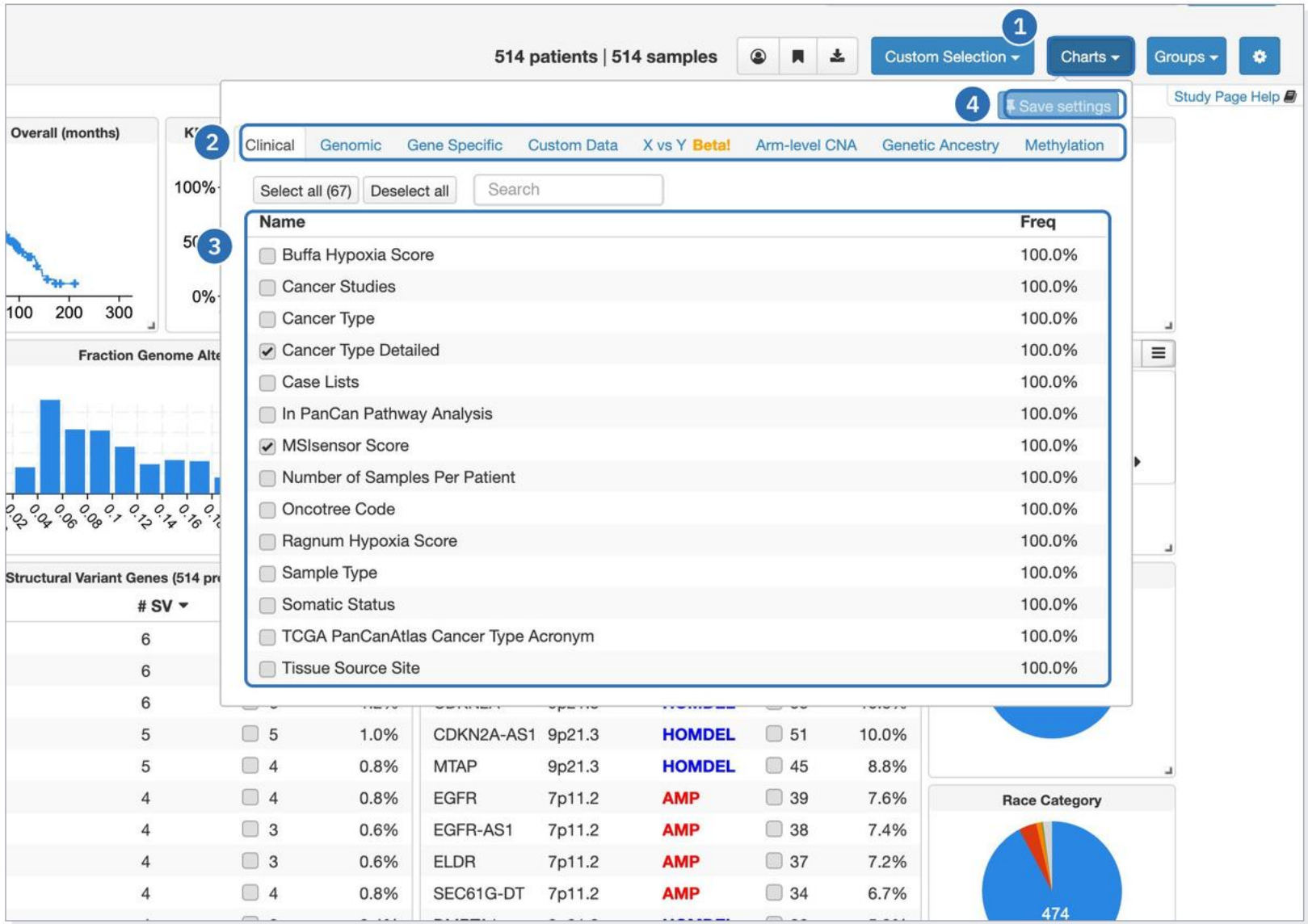
Link to this page

Study View: groups, custom selection and sharing



1. "View selected cases" opens the selected cases in the Patient View (see Tutorial 3).
2. "Share Virtual Study" saves the selection as a virtual study (see Tutorial 4).
3. Download clinical data for the selected cases.
4. "Custom Selection": paste a list of sample or patient IDs to filter to.
5. "Groups": create a group from the selected samples and compare groups (see Tutorial 6).

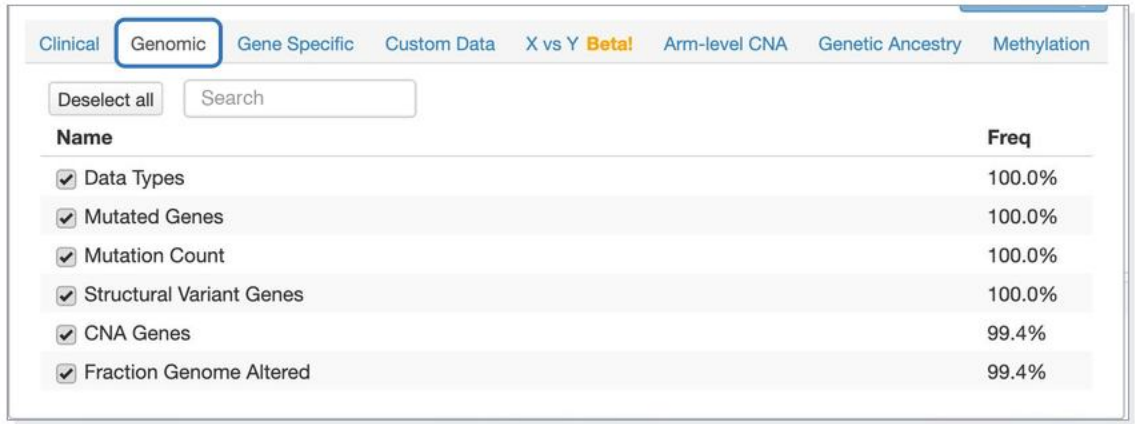
Summary tab: adding charts



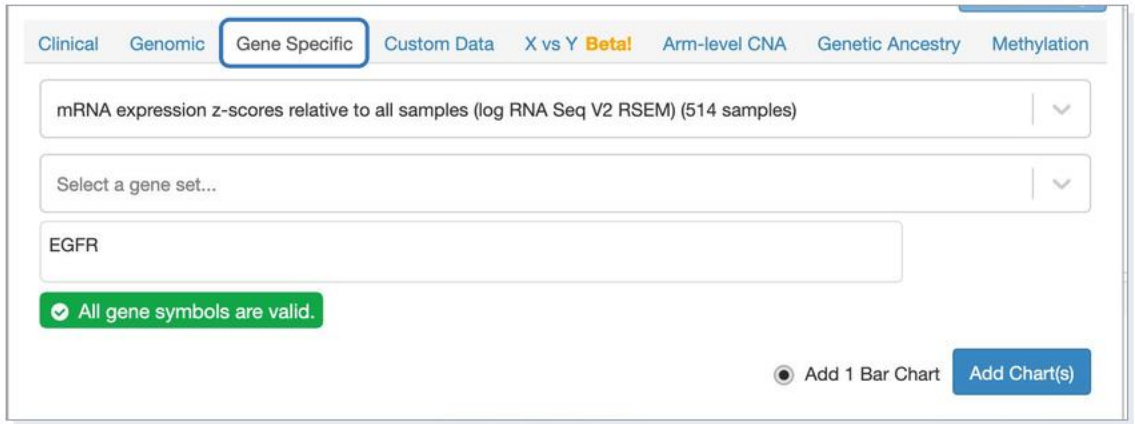
1. The “Charts” menu adds charts. They work like any other: filter, compare, download.
2. Kinds of charts to add, grouped by data type. Some tabs appear only for studies with that data (see the next slide).
3. Tick attributes to show them. “Freq” is the share of samples with data.
4. When logged in, “Save settings” keeps this chart layout.

Link to this page

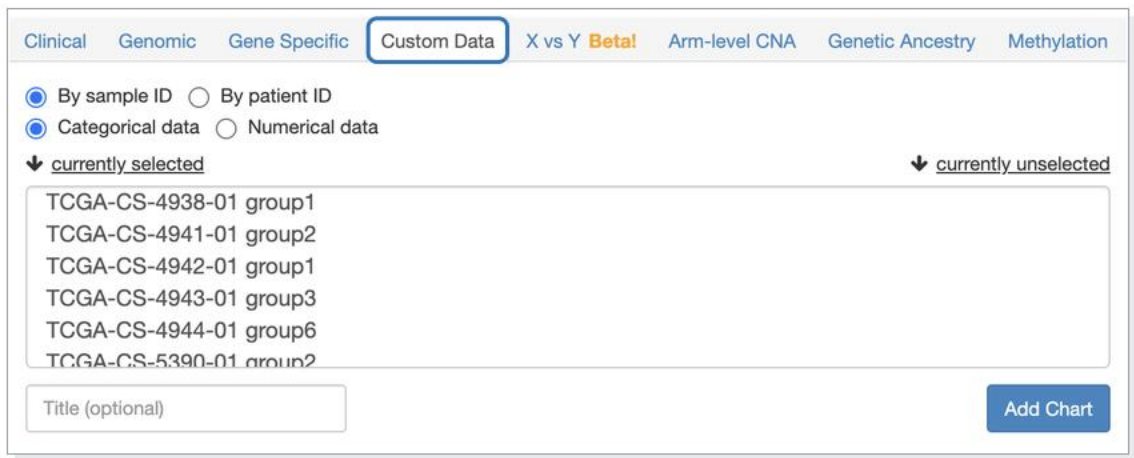
Summary tab: more kinds of charts



Genomic: charts that summarize the genomic data (mutated genes, CNA genes, mutation count, ...).



Gene Specific: a chart for one gene from any profile with continuous data. Here, EGFR mRNA expression.



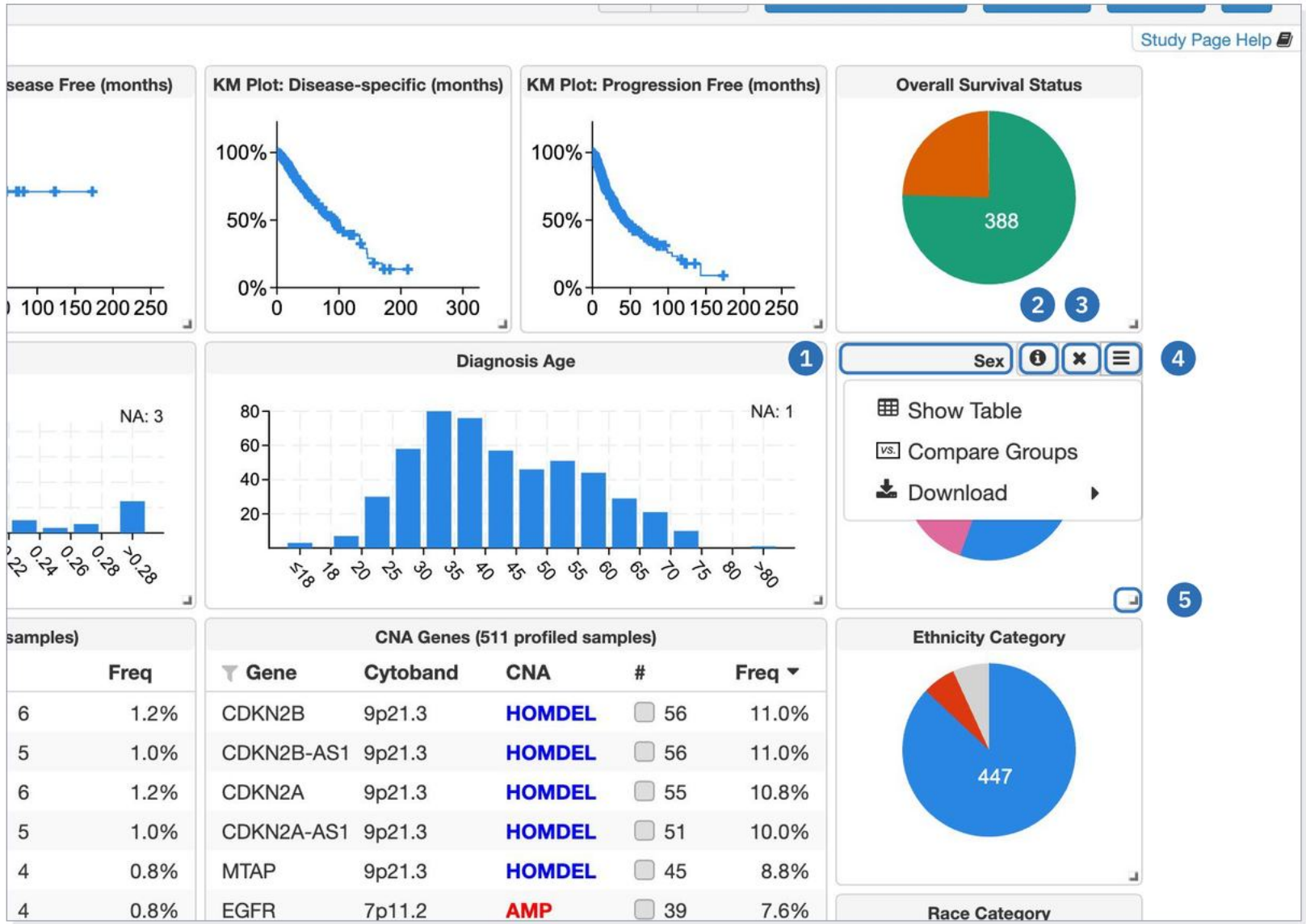
Custom Data: paste your own values for the samples, e.g. groups from your own analysis. You need to be logged in.



X vs Y (Beta): a chart of two clinical attributes.

Link to this page

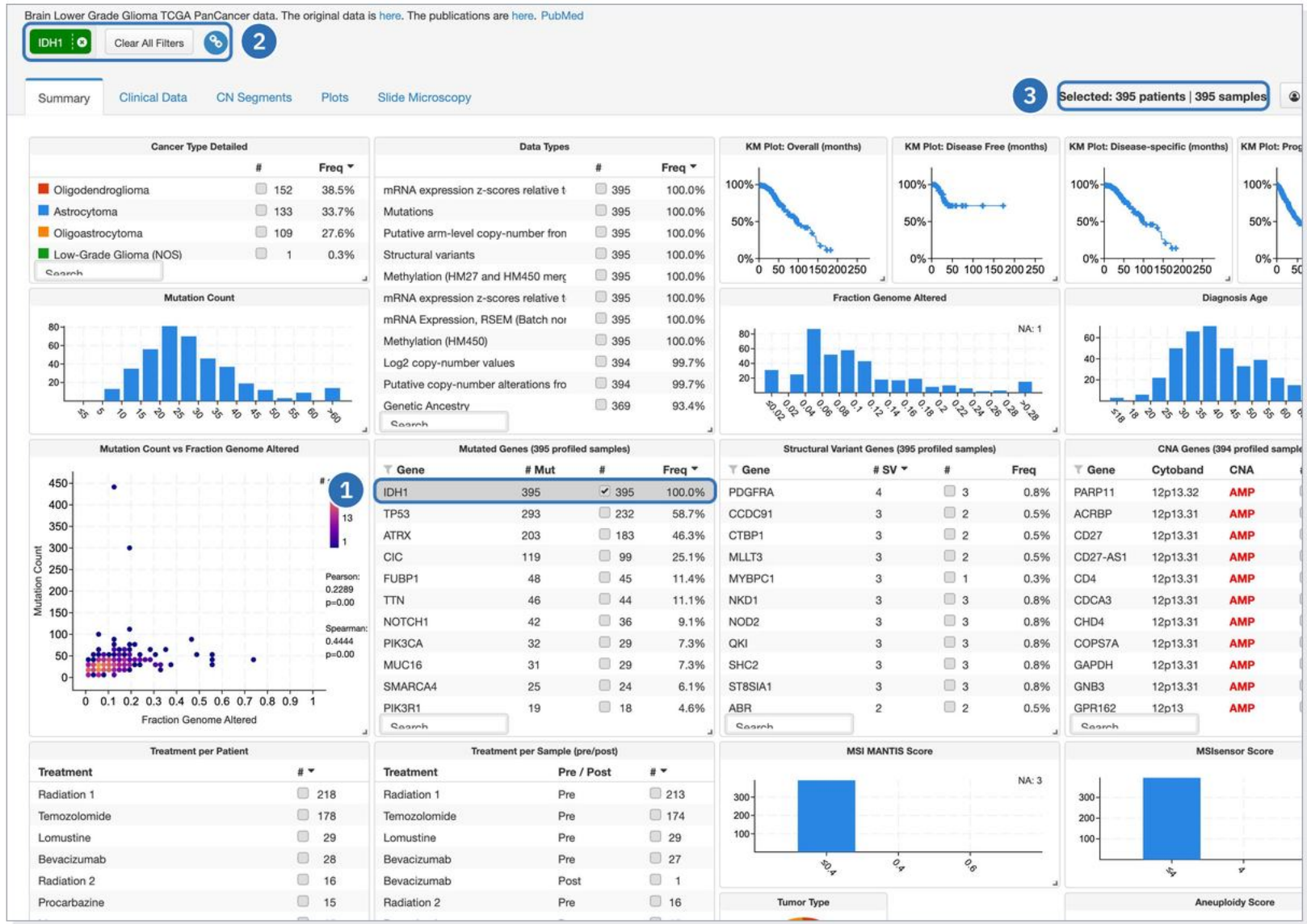
Summary tab: working with charts



1. Hover over a chart's title bar to show its buttons. Drag the title bar to move the chart.
2. The info button describes the data.
3. The “x” button removes the chart.
4. Hover over the menu icon for “Show Table”, “Compare Groups” (one group per value, see Tutorial 6) and “Download”.
5. Drag the corner to resize the chart.

Link to this page

Summary tab: selecting a subset of samples



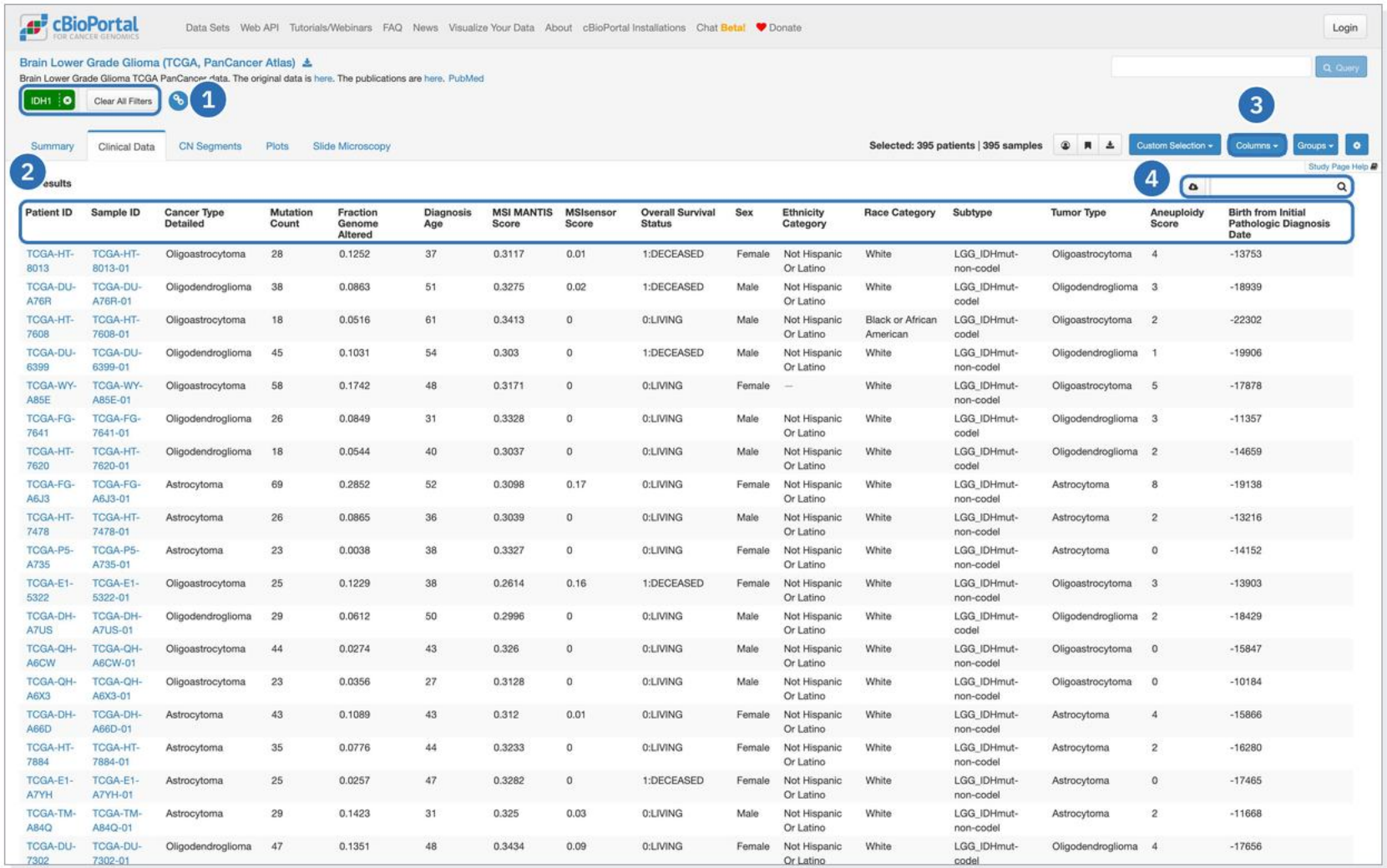
1. Use any chart to select samples. Here, tick IDH1 in Mutated Genes, then click “Select Samples”.

2. Active filters are listed here. Click “x” on a filter to remove it, or “Clear All Filters”. The link button copies a shareable link with the filters applied.

3. All charts update to the IDH1-mutant samples. Add more filters to narrow down.

Link to this page

Clinical Data tab

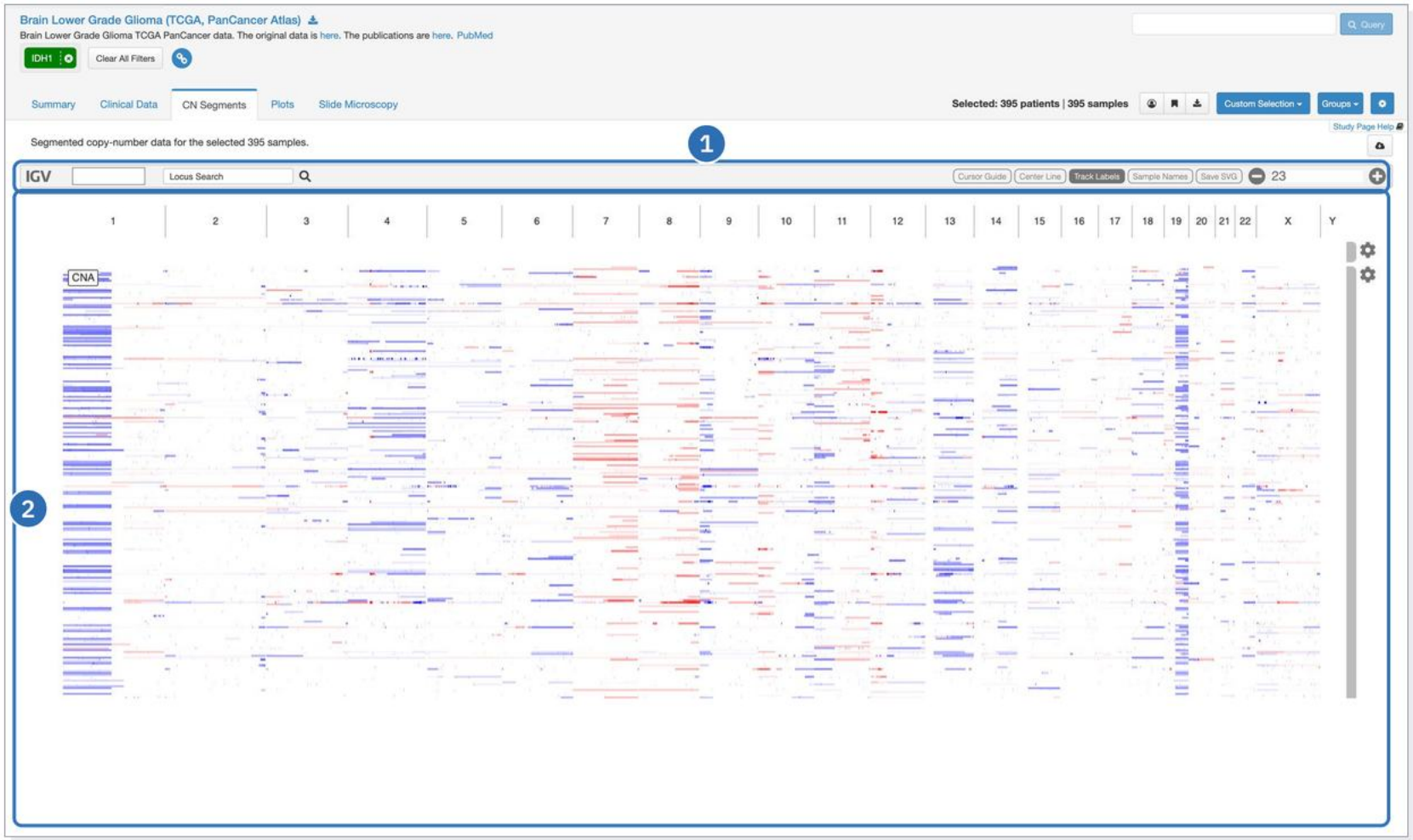


Patient ID	Sample ID	Cancer Type Detailed	Mutation Count	Fraction Genome Altered	Diagnosis Age	MSI MANTIS Score	MSIsensor Score	Overall Survival Status	Sex	Ethnicity Category	Race Category	Subtype	Tumor Type	Aneuploidy Score	Birth from Initial Pathologic Diagnosis Date
TCGA-HT-8013	TCGA-HT-8013-01	Oligoastrocytoma	28	0.1252	37	0.3117	0.01	1:DECEASED	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Oligoastrocytoma	4	-13753
TCGA-DU-A76R	TCGA-DU-A76R-01	Oligodendroglioma	38	0.0863	51	0.3275	0.02	1:DECEASED	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligodendroglioma	3	-18939
TCGA-HT-7608	TCGA-HT-7608-01	Oligoastrocytoma	18	0.0516	61	0.3413	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	Black or African American	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligoastrocytoma	2	-22302
TCGA-DU-6399	TCGA-DU-6399-01	Oligodendroglioma	45	0.1031	54	0.303	0	1:DECEASED	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligodendroglioma	1	-19906
TCGA-WY-A85E	TCGA-WY-A85E-01	Oligoastrocytoma	58	0.1742	48	0.3171	0	0:LIVING	Female	--	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Oligoastrocytoma	5	-17878
TCGA-FG-7641	TCGA-FG-7641-01	Oligodendroglioma	26	0.0849	31	0.3328	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligodendroglioma	3	-11357
TCGA-HT-7620	TCGA-HT-7620-01	Oligodendroglioma	18	0.0544	40	0.3037	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligodendroglioma	2	-14659
TCGA-FG-A6J3	TCGA-FG-A6J3-01	Astrocytoma	69	0.2852	52	0.3098	0.17	0:LIVING	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	8	-19138
TCGA-HT-7478	TCGA-HT-7478-01	Astrocytoma	26	0.0865	36	0.3039	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	2	-13216
TCGA-P5-A735	TCGA-P5-A735-01	Astrocytoma	23	0.0038	38	0.3327	0	0:LIVING	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	0	-14152
TCGA-E1-5322	TCGA-E1-5322-01	Oligoastrocytoma	25	0.1229	38	0.2614	0.16	1:DECEASED	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Oligoastrocytoma	3	-13903
TCGA-DH-A7US	TCGA-DH-A7US-01	Oligodendroglioma	29	0.0612	50	0.2996	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligodendroglioma	2	-18429
TCGA-QH-A6CW	TCGA-QH-A6CW-01	Oligoastrocytoma	44	0.0274	43	0.326	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Oligoastrocytoma	0	-15847
TCGA-QH-A6X3	TCGA-QH-A6X3-01	Oligoastrocytoma	23	0.0356	27	0.3128	0	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Oligoastrocytoma	0	-10184
TCGA-DH-A66D	TCGA-DH-A66D-01	Astrocytoma	43	0.1089	43	0.312	0.01	0:LIVING	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	4	-15866
TCGA-HT-7884	TCGA-HT-7884-01	Astrocytoma	35	0.0776	44	0.3233	0	0:LIVING	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	2	-16280
TCGA-E1-A7YH	TCGA-E1-A7YH-01	Astrocytoma	25	0.0257	47	0.3282	0	1:DECEASED	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	0	-17465
TCGA-TM-A84Q	TCGA-TM-A84Q-01	Astrocytoma	29	0.1423	31	0.325	0.03	0:LIVING	Male	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-non-codel	Astrocytoma	2	-11668
TCGA-DU-7302	TCGA-DU-7302-01	Oligodendroglioma	47	0.1351	48	0.3434	0.09	0:LIVING	Female	Not Hispanic Or Latino	White	LGG_IDHmut-codel	Oligodendroglioma	4	-17656

1. Filters from the Summary tab apply here: only the IDH1-mutant samples.
2. Click a column header to sort. Scroll right for more columns.
3. The “Columns” menu shows more attributes (they vary by study).
4. Download or search the table.

Link to this page

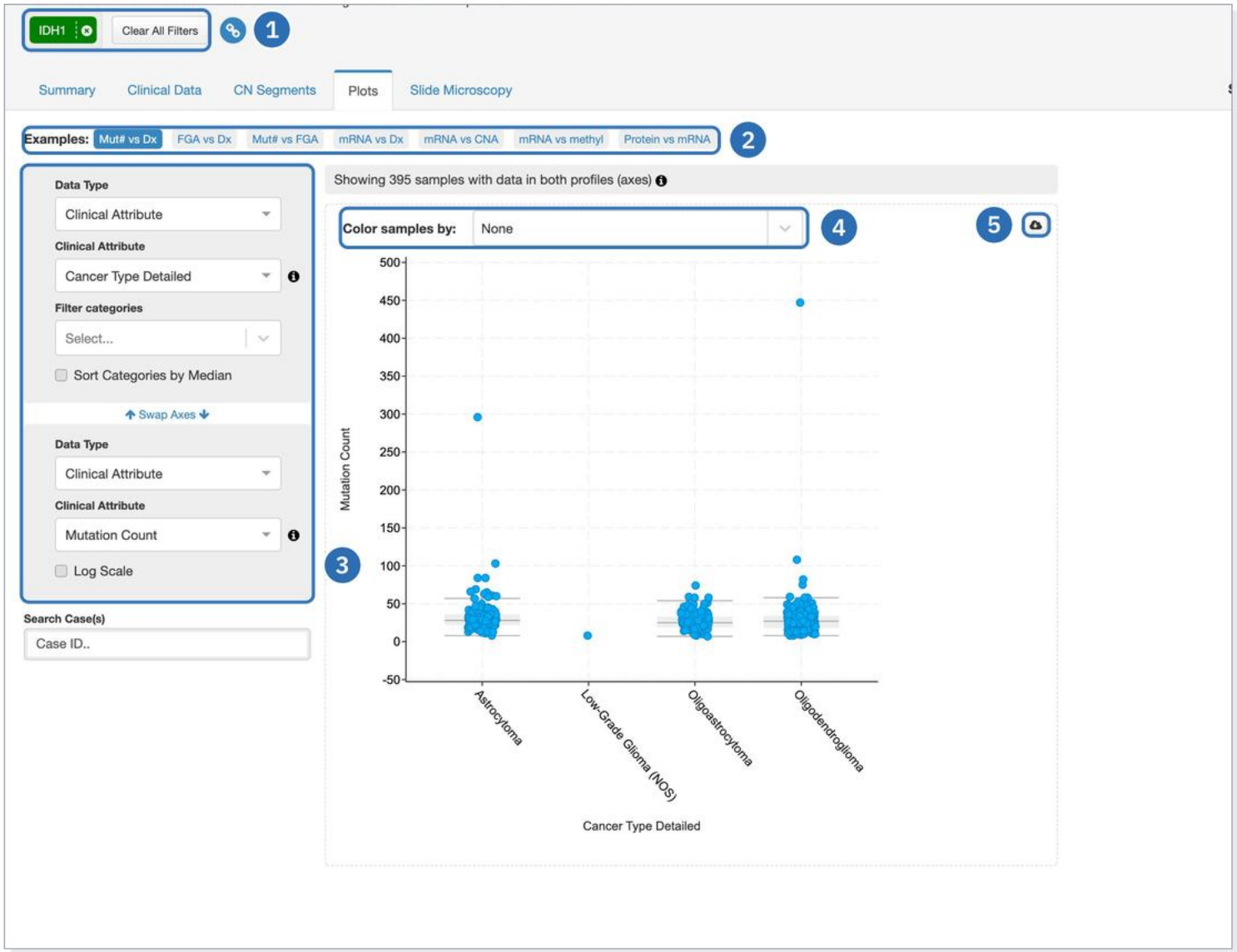
CN Segments tab



1. Enter a gene or genomic coordinates to zoom in. Filters from the Summary tab apply.
2. The Integrative Genomics Viewer (IGV) shows segments across the genome, one row per sample.

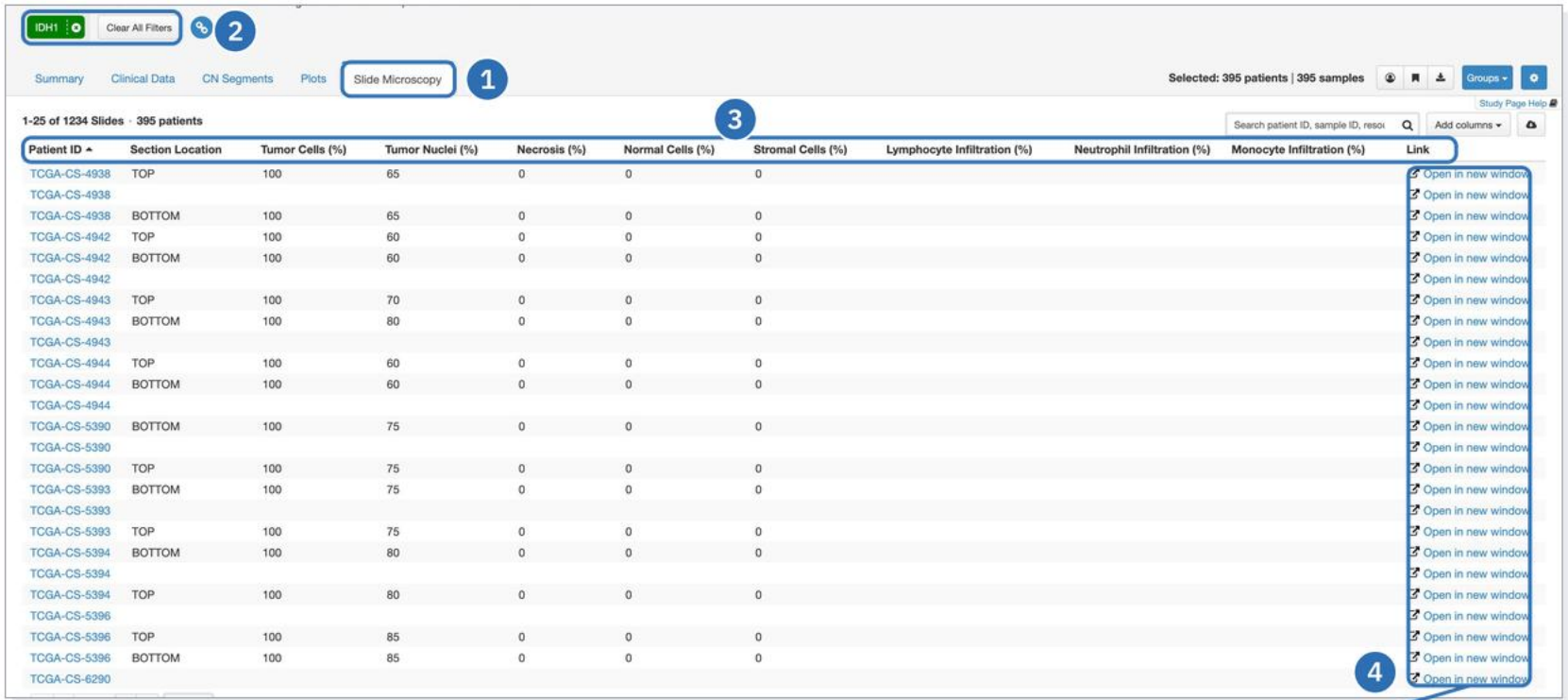
Link to this page

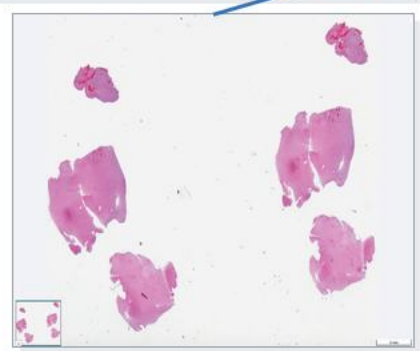
Plots tab



1. Filters from the Summary tab apply here: only the IDH1-mutant samples are plotted.
2. Start from an example, such as mutation count by cancer type ("Mut# vs Dx").
3. Or choose the data type and attribute for each axis: clinical attributes, mutations, copy number, expression and more.
4. Color samples by another attribute.
5. Download the plot or its data.

Slide Microscopy tab

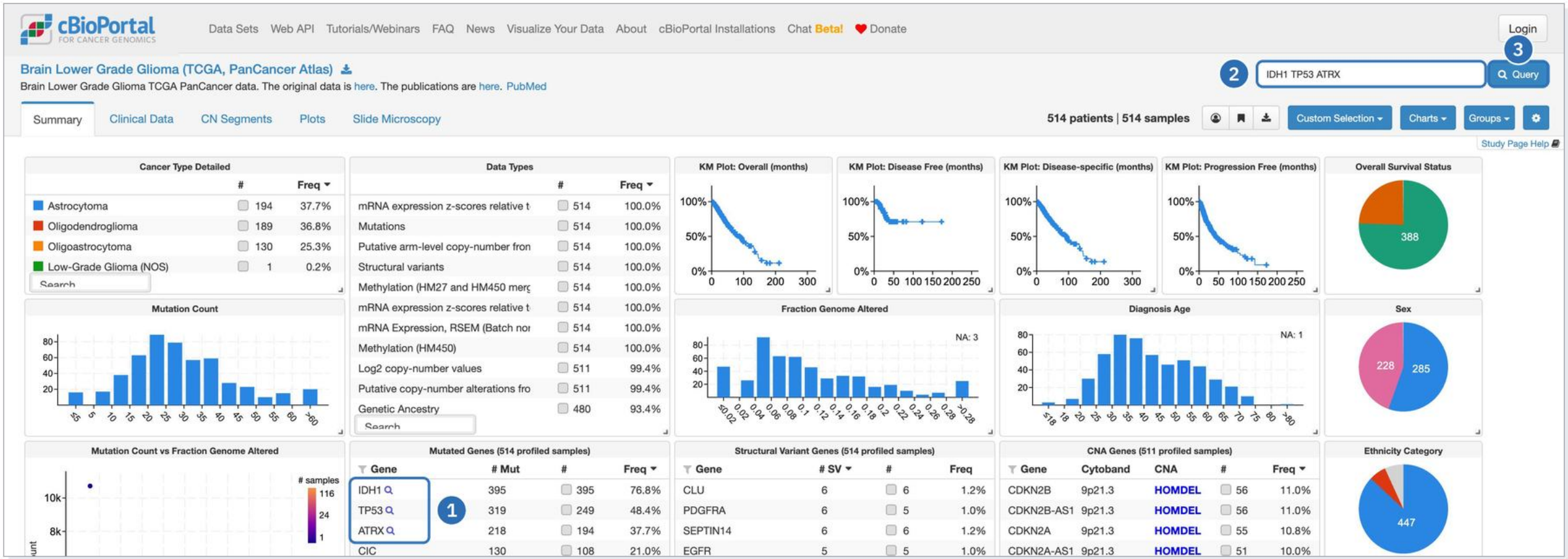




1. Shown for studies with H&E slide images.
2. Slides of the selected patients: the IDH1 filter from the Summary tab applies.
3. One row per slide, with pathology annotations: tumor cells, tumor nuclei, necrosis (%).
4. Open a slide in the NCI Imaging Data Commons viewer. Below: a whole slide (TCGA-CS-4938, FFPE H&E).

Link to this page

Study View: run a query



1. Back on the Summary tab: click the search icon next to a gene in any genomic table to add it to the query. Apply filters first to query only the selected samples.

2. Or type gene symbols here.

3. Then click “Query” (see Tutorial 2).

Link to this page



Questions?

More tutorials: cbioportal.org/tutorials

Documentation: docs.cbioportal.org

Email us: cbioportal@googlegroups.com